



Fonds Nouvelles frontières en recherche
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The MBI Project draws upon research supported by the Government of Canada's New Frontiers in Research Fund (NFRF).

Marine Biomass Innovation (MBI) Newsletter

Word of the Day

Pjila'si

(Welcome)

In the Mi'kmaw language, this is a commonly shared concept of welcome. It is also a warm invitation for the offering of space and belonging. Pi'la'si reflects our Mi'kmaw values of hospitality, respect, inclusion, relationship-building, and making someone feel they have a place within the gathering or community. Come and be among us.

Source/credit line:

Shared by Chief Terri Greene, Elmastukwek First Nation, Benoit's Cove Indian Band

Community Corner



Chief Terri gardening, By the Bay Community Garden, Park Drive, Benoit's Cove.



Chief Terri , in front of the store in York Harbour



Bay of Islands / Elmastukwek

Blessed, to have the Blow Me Down Mountains as the backdrop of our lives, and the breathtaking yet unforgiving Atlantic as our front yard, the southern shore of the Bay of Islands is deeply rooted in culture, using each season and every terrain to make life full, whether that's on skidoo in the backcountry, or boating to Wood's Island to family owned cabins, on land passed down through generations. We find joy in the land and water that hold our history.

From Cook's Brook to Lark Harbour, our people have lived through generations of erasure, times when cultural identity was a secret and people carried a deep, undeserved shame. With the resurgence of the Benoit's Cove Indian Band in 2022, community is once again reclaiming our voice, teachings, and right to be seen, sparking a powerful return rooted in truth, pride, and cultural strength.

Community Corner



Community Based Researcher Children, two children digging with shovel, sampling on the Shoal, Benois Cove.



Chief Terri with children, the harbour on Woods Island, Summer 2025.

Today, we hand down teachings openly, building up our youth with confidence and purpose. Through the Marine Biomass Innovation project, research shows remarkable potential for community, bringing forward innovative ideas shaped by both environmental leadership and ancestral knowledge.

Community members are investing in themselves by taking ECO Canada micro-credentials and strengthening the skills that support long-term community resilience. Our dedication is to ensure emotional, financial, and cultural security for every person who calls this coastline home.

The community is alive with renewed energy, hope, and collective purpose as people rising together, guided by mountains, ocean, and the teachings that have always carried us.



Chief Terri on Seadoo

Community Happenings

Past Events

Community Engagement: Mawio'mi Season with Community Partners (Mawio'mi) 2026

Together with our Mi'kmaq Community Partners, our MBI Team had memorable summer throughout Mawio'mi season. These gatherings provide an opportunity to connect with and support our community members along with sharing information about the MBI Project.

Our first event was the 18th Annual Bay St. George Powwow in Flat Bay, held July 10-12, 2026. The following weekend, the team attended the 2026 Penwaaq L'nu'k Mawio'mi at Benoit First Nation in Cape St. George, held July 17-18.



Past Events



From left to right: Frankie Young, Karen Doody, Chief Terri Greene, Chief Joanne Miles, Chief Kevin Lee, Nina in the annual Bay St George Powwow



From left to right: Matt Perrier, Brooke Chaisson-Young, Frankie Young in the annual Bay St George Powwow

Community Happenings

The MBI booth was also a popular gathering place for visitors of all ages. Participants enjoyed our Marine Trivia activity, spinning the wheel to answer marine-related questions, receiving a sweet treat, and entering for a chance to win a prize.

These gatherings provide a meaningful opportunity to connect with community members, support our partners, and share information about the Marine Biomass Innovation Project.

Wela'liog to our Mi'kmaq Community Partners for welcoming the MBI Team to be part of these special celebrations!

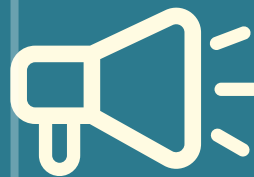


MBI Team Participated in the annual Bay St George Powwow

Future Events

Community Happenings

Benoit First Nation Community Garden - Fall Harvest



To be determine

Women's Full Moon Ceremony

Event Details:

Women's Full Moon Ceremony

Organized by: Flat Bay-St. Teresa's Native Women's Association

Hosted by: Mary King

Date: September 26

Time: 7:00 PM

Location: Calm Waters Park, Flat Bay

Women's Full Moon Ceremony

Hosted by:
Mary King

September 26th @ 7:00pm
Location: Calm Waters Park,
Flat Bay.

Please bring your moon water jars, drum
and ribbon skirt (if you have one) a chair and
dress warm.

Flat Bay-St. Teresa's
Native Women's Association

National Day for Truth and Reconciliation

Event Details:

Benoit First Nation and Flat Bay Band Activities

Date: September 30, 2026.

Time: Starts at 1 PM.

Location: Community Gathering, Mi'kmaw Center.

SEPTEMBER 30
NATIONAL DAY
for
TRUTH AND RECONCILIATION
A DAY FOR REFLECTION, REMEMBRANCE, AND ACTION

Community Gathering • Mi'kmaw Centre

- Join us for:
- Smudging Ceremony
- Walk down Kluskap's Walking Trail
- Talking Circle on the importance of this day
- Starts at 1 PM downstairs

Snacks and refreshments will be handed
out to the children in attendance.

Community Happenings

Future Events



Every Child Matters – National Day for Truth and Reconciliation

Event Details:

Orange Shirt Day Gathering – Bay of Islands

Date: September 30, 2026.

Time: 2:00–4:00 PM

Location: Town of Humber Arm South Community Hall.



Orange Shirt Day – National Day for Truth and Reconciliation

Event Details:

Event: Orange Shirt Day – National Day for Truth and Reconciliation

Organized by: Flat Bay-St. Teresa's Native Women's Association

Date: September 30

Location: The People's Complex

Doors open: 11:30 AM



Future Events

New abstract deadline → extended to Sept. 8!

RELATIONAL RESEARCH: AN INDIGENOUS HEALTH RESEARCH SYMPOSIUM

The deadline for abstract submissions has been extended to September 8. If you have Indigenous health research, community-based knowledge, emerging work, or other contributions you would like to share, we encourage you to submit your abstract.

For more info or to submit your abstract, scan the QR code:



Wela'lioq, tshinashkumitinau, nakummek, thank you.



Community Happenings

Relational Research: An Indigenous Health Research Symposium

The Symposium brings together people from diverse disciplines, sectors, and backgrounds to share research, experiences, and developments in Indigenous health and health research. We invite you to join us for a day of learning, sharing, connection, and conversation.

Event Details:

Date: October 1, 2026

Format: Virtual and in-person options

Location: Memorial University's Grenfell Campus, Corner Brook, NL on the ancestral homelands of the Mi'kmaq of Ktaqmkuk

Cost: Free

10th Annual All-Nations Powwow

Join the 10th Annual All-Nations Powwow, hosted by Grenfell Campus' Office of Indigenous Affairs on Sunday, October 4, in the Arts and Science Atrium (AS 2C01). Gather with us from 11:00 AM-3:00 PM, with an opening reception at 11:00 AM followed by Grand Entry at 1:00 PM.

Event Details:

Date: October 4, 2026

Format: Virtual and in-person options

Location: Arts and Science Atrium (AS 2C01), Memorial University's Grenfell Campus, Corner Brook, NL.

Research Feature

Etuaptmumk in Action



From Left to right: Lord Abbey, Mumtaz Cheema, Ayesha Priyadarshani Rathnayake, Nina Tourett-Retieffe, Raphael Ofoe, Brooke Chaisson-Young, Md. Rana Parvez



Raphael Ofoe.

In this issue of the MBI Newsletter, we are featuring two researchers from Work Package 4 of the MBI project whose work demonstrates how community knowledge, local priorities, and scientific research can come together through Etuaptmumk (Two-Eyed Seeing).

Raphael Ofoe - Dalhousie University

Raphael Ofoe is a Postdoctoral Fellow with MBI and works in the Plant Stress Physiology and Biostimulant Research Group at Dalhousie University's Agricultural Campus under the supervision of Dr. Lord Abbey. His research explores how marine waste streams, including seaweed byproducts, can be transformed into sustainable biostimulants that support crop productivity and resilience to environmental stress.

Community collaboration has played an important role in shaping Raphael's research. Through work with Mi'kmaw communities in the Bay St. George and Bay of Islands regions, community partners helped guide sampling locations, identify culturally significant species, and share knowledge about traditional uses of marine materials. These conversations also helped shape the project around local priorities such as reducing marine waste, supporting coastal livelihoods, and developing agricultural tools that respond to community needs.

Engagement with Indigenous knowledge also changed how Raphael viewed marine biomass, not simply as waste to be managed, but as part of a broader ecological and cultural system. This perspective encouraged approaches based on stewardship, minimal disturbance, reciprocal benefit, and low-impact extraction, while considering how the resulting biostimulants could contribute to local food systems.

Research Feature



Ayesha Priyadarshani Rathnayake.



Community Garden.

Etuaptmumk in Action

One highlight has been co-developing school demonstrations and community garden initiatives, where researchers, youth, community members, and Chiefs have worked together to explore how locally available marine materials can benefit plants and soils.

Raphael's advice to future community-based researchers: start by listening, remain flexible as community priorities evolve, and think about what the research can give back, not only what researchers hope to gain from the community.

Ayesha Priyadarshani Rathnayake - Memorial University

Ayesha Priyadarshani Rathnayake is a Master's student in Boreal Ecosystems and Agricultural Science at Memorial University's Grenfell Campus. She worked in the Boreal Ecosystems Research Initiative (BERI) lab under the supervision of Dr. Lakshman Galagedara and Dr. Mumtaz Cheema.

Her research focuses on developing a carbon nanofertilizer from lobster shell waste. Lobster shells were sourced from four Indigenous communities, Flat Bay Band, Bay St. George Band, Three Rivers Band, and Benoit First Nation Band, where families already use shell waste as a nutrient for gardens. Rather than treating this existing practice as separate from the scientific research, Ayesha incorporated it directly into her experimental design as the control treatment.

Research Feature

Etuaptmumk in Action



Ayesha Priyadarshani Rathnayake,
Raphael Ofoe.

Guided by Etuaptmumk, her research brought Indigenous and local knowledge together with nanotechnology. The traditional practice of applying lobster shell waste directly to plants became one “eye,” while the development and testing of a lobster-shell-derived nanofertilizer provided the complementary scientific perspective. This allowed the research to ask whether the new technology could improve upon an existing community practice rather than replacing it.

Ayesha also worked with students at Bayview Academy and Our Lady of the Cape School, where students conducted plant-growth experiments using the same lobster-shell treatments used in her thesis. These activities connected classroom science with local materials and community knowledge, creating a practical example of Two-Eyed Seeing in action.

Ayesha’s advice to future community-based researchers: begin with the community’s existing practices and priorities rather than with a laboratory idea alone, and invest time in building relationships before you need data.



Ayesha Priyadarshani Rathnayake

Kelp Fest - Halifax, NS, June 9-11, 2026



From left to right: Bohdan Luhovyy, Chief Joanne Miles, Chief Terri Greene, Nina Tourett-Retieffe, Meaghan Cahill, Karen Doody, Priya Kathivel - Mount St. Vincent University



Conference Report

MBI Partners Explore Atlantic Canada's Kelp Sector at Kelp Fest - Halifax, NS, June 9-11, 2026

MBI partners Chief Terri Greene, Chief Joanne Miles, Dr. Karen Doody, Priya Kathivel, and Mi'kmaw Community Engagement Coordinator Nina Tourett-Retieffe recently attended a conference focused on the growing kelp sector in Atlantic Canada.

The conference provided valuable insights into kelp cultivation, sustainable governance models, collaboration, commercialization, and market opportunities.



Kelp Fest – Halifax, NS, June 9-11, 2026



Shannon Arnold, Ecology Action Centre, kelp dryer demonstration.

Conference Report

During the visit, the group toured Priya Kathirvel and Bohdan Luhovyy's laboratories at Mount Saint Vincent University, including their food and health research facilities.

On the final day, Chiefs Greene and Miles, Dr. Doody, and Nina visited Dalhousie University's Aquatron Laboratory. The group explored the facility's impressive aquarium and research spaces, including kelp growing tanks with various stages of growth, a kelp growth lab, and a mussel research lab.

The experience provided MBI partners with valuable firsthand knowledge of the research and innovation supporting the future of Atlantic Canada's marine and kelp sectors.



From left to right: Karen Doody, , Nina Tourett-Retieffe,, M Chief Joanne Miles, Chief Terri Greene.

MBI Calendar

SEPTEMBER 2026

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
			1	2	3	4 5
6	7	8	9	10	11	12
13	14	15	16	17	18	19
20	21	22	23	24	25	26 Women's Full Moon Ceremony
27	28	29 Orange Shirt Day Gathering - Bay of Islands Orange Shirt Day - Flat Bay Truth & Reconciliation Gathering - Benoit & Flat Bay	30			

MBI Calendar

OCTOBER 2026

[illegible]

MBI Calendar

NOVEMBER 2026

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14	
15	16	17	18	19	20	21	
22	23	24	25	26	27	28	
29	30						